TOP THREE CONTENDERS FOR WCOTY ANNOUNCED



The top-three finalists of each category in the World Car of the Year Awards 2022 (WCOTY) have been announced. The six categories—World Car of the Year, World Urban Car, World Electric Vehicle of the Year, World Luxury Car, World Performance Car and World Car Design of the Year—are voted on by a jury of 102 automotive journalists from around the world. Yogendra Pratap, editor, *Auto Today*, is a juror for WCOTY. The winners will be announced on April 13, 2022.

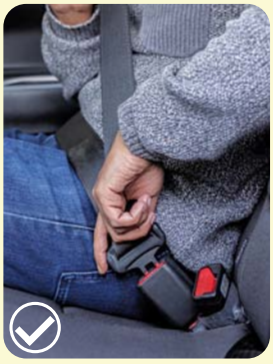
The top three contenders for World Car of the Year 2022 are the Ford Mustang Mach-E, the Hyundai Ioniq 5 and the Kia EV6. The top three contenders for the World Urban Car of the Year include the Opel Mokka, the Toyota Yaris Cross, and the India-made VW Taigun. As far as the World Electric Vehicle of the Year finalists are concerned, the Audi e-Tron GT, the Hyundai Ioniq 5 and the Mercedes-Benz EQS are the final contenders. The finalists in the World Luxury Car of the Year are the BMW iX, the Genesis GV70 and the Mercedes-Benz EQS. When it comes to the World Performance Car of the Year, the finalists include the Audi e-Tron GT, the BMW M3/M4 and the Toyota GR86/ Subaru BRZ. The final award then is the World Car Design of the Year and the finalists include the Audi e-Tron GT, the Hyundai Ioniq 5 and the Kia EV6.

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RIGHT POSTURE, RIGHT DRIVING





Have you ever thought that the position you take when driving could affect driving comfort, car control and, above all, safety? Aspects definitely not to be taken too lightly, but unfortunately correct posture while driving a vehicle is often overlooked. Drivers often ignore the fact that correct driving position can give them better control of the car and increase comfort behind the wheel. The driving position should also be adjusted to maintain ample distance from the steering so that the driver doesn't get injured when there is a collision and airbags are deployed.

The four-step approach elaborated below will help you find the optimum driving position.



1. THE SEAT SQUAB

The first step is to adjust your distance from the pedals. The seat squab adjuster can be used to move the seat forward or backward. Make sure that when you fully press down on the brake pedal, there should be a slight bend in your knees. This will ensure optimum braking pressure can be applied when needed. It will also keep your legs relaxed and comfortable.

2. THE SEAT BACK



Next, to determine reach from the steering wheel, adjust the seat back. With both hands on the steering wheel, turn the steering lock to lock to ensure your arms do not stretch. Adjust the seatback so your elbows are slightly bent. The seat back should be positioned so that your wrist hangs over the top of the steering wheel. Make sure that your back is perfectly resting on the backrest, the hands are positioned at 9.15 with arms slightly bent and the elbows at the height of the abdomen.



3. THE STEERING COLUMN

Before you begin driving, the height of the steering column can also be adjusted. To move the steering column up or down, push the lever underneath the column all the way down. Move the steering wheel into the desired position and push the lever back up to lock the steering wheel in that position.

4. THE MIRRORS



Use your mirrors to help you be a safe driver, they must be positioned correctly. When positioned properly, you should be able to see directly behind your car using the rear-view mirror, as well as into the spaces near the rear corners of your car with the side mirrors. Most modern cars have an electronic switch that controls the position of the left and right-side view mirrors. To adjust the rear-view mirror, make sure you sit normally and manually move the mirror until your view is straight, centered and level. The goal is always to maximize the rear view.

Once you are in the correct position, it is time to buckle up. On many car models it is possible to adjust the height of the attachment of the belts. It is good to take advantage of this possibility by choosing a position that allows the upper band to pass through the centre of the collarbone, while the lower one must be well adherent at the pelvis and not at the abdomen.